

KGE · DESIGN SYSTEM

Design *with* discipline.

KGE is a premium macOS focus companion. Its design language is **ultra-minimal, monochrome, understated** — everything stripped to its essential weight. One surface. One accent. One voice.

PRINCIPLE 01 Quiet authority Nothing competes for attention. The work does.	PRINCIPLE 02 Earned density Data appears only when it informs a decision.	PRINCIPLE 03 Mono precision Numbers always in JetBrains Mono. Never serif, never sans.	PRINCIPLE 04 Zero color noise One warm bone-white accent. No gradients. No color UI.
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Color

A single-surface system. Three depths of dark + one text value with four opacities. Never introduce hue unless a semantic need demands it (error, success).

SURFACE SCALE

-bg
#0A0A0B

Canvas. The deepest layer. Window background.

-surface
#0E0E10

Sidebar, panels, cards at rest.

-elev
#17171A

Hover states, selected rows, active tabs.

-elev2
#1F1F23

Popovers, tooltips, active input bg.

-glass
rgba(20,18,16,0.72)

Widget overlays only. Always with backdrop-filter.

TEXT SCALE · ALL FROM #E8E7E3

Aa

-TEXT

#E8E7E3 · opacity 1.0

Headings, active labels, timer numerals, primary content.

Aa

-MUTE

#E8E7E3 · opacity 0.56

Secondary labels, body text, descriptions.

Aa

-DIM

#E8E7E3 · opacity 0.34

Tertiary labels, metadata, timestamps.

Aa

-FAINT

#E8E7E3 · opacity 0.10

Inactive chain cells, empty progress, placeholder fills.

SEMANTIC COLORS · MINIMAL USE

SUCCESS / OVER TARGET

#7AD1B6

Chain milestone reached, over-target time. Text only, never background fills. Use sparingly.

WARNING / CHAIN BREAK

#E86450 · 80%

Chain broken, missed session. Text only. Only appears on Stats and Home screens.

AT RISK

#FFC850 · 70%

Chain not yet started today but window open. Used in sidebar chain list.

- + NEVER use a gradient on UI surfaces. Gradients are only permitted on decorative desktop bg in Timer widget.
- + NEVER add a new color without DS approval. Semantic colors are the only exception to monochrome rule.
- + Border/divider lines: always 0.5px — never 1px. Line tokens already encoded above.

LINE / BORDER TOKENS

-LINE

rgba(255,255,255,0.06)

Default dividers, card borders, table rows. Most common border.

-LINE-STRONG

rgba(255,255,255,0.12)

Focused inputs, selected card outline, widget borders.

-LINE-HEAVY

rgba(255,255,255,0.22)

Active accent borders (KGE toggle on, selected event). Use sparingly.

Type

Three typefaces, three distinct roles. Never mix roles. The combination creates a hierarchy without needing color or weight variation.

ROLE · DISPLAY / EDITORIAL <i>KGE</i> Instrument Serif Google Fonts · Free Weights: 400 regular + italic Use: Onboarding headlines, screen titles, pull quotes, numerical hero text on stats.	ROLE · UI / BODY KGE Inter Tight Google Fonts · Free Weights: 300, 400, 500, 600 Use: All UI text, buttons, nav, body copy, event titles. Default fallback: -apple-system.	ROLE · DATA / NUMBERS KGE JetBrains Mono Google Fonts · Free Weights: 300, 400, 500 Use: All numerals (timers, durations, KPIs), metadata labels, tag names, timestamps.
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TYPE SCALE

Display · 96px
Instrument Serif · Regular
tracking -2px · lh 0.92
Context: Onboarding hero

Calendar.

Heading 1 · 52px
Instrument Serif · Regular
tracking -1px · lh 1.0
Context: Screen titles, stats hero

486 hours of focus.

Heading 2 · 36px
Inter Tight · 300
tracking -0.8px · lh 1.05
Context: Panel titles, event names

Draft Q2 research synthesis

Heading 3 · 24px
Inter Tight · 400
tracking -0.3px · lh 1.2
Context: Card titles, modal titles

Today · Tuesday, 14 April

Body · 14px
Inter Tight · 400
tracking 0 · lh 1.6
Context: Descriptions, notes

KGE lives beside Apple Calendar. When you want an event to become a focused session, just select it as KGE — a timer will appear the moment it begins.

Caption · 12px
Inter Tight · 400
tracking 0 · lh 1.5
Context: Footnotes, sub-labels

Calendar access is read-only and can be revoked in System Settings at any time.

Timer • 56px
JetBrains Mono • 300
tracking -1px • lh 1
Context: Live timer numerals

01:28:42

KPI • 32px
JetBrains Mono • 400
tracking -0.5px • lh 1
Context: Stats KPI values

486 hours

Label • 10px
JetBrains Mono • 400
tracking +1.2px • uppercase
Context: Section headers,
metadata

TODAY • 14 APRIL • TUESDAY • W16

Note input • 22px
Instrument Serif • Italic
Context: Post-session text input

Synthesized the three interview transcripts into four themes.

Space

4px base unit. All spacing values are multiples of 4. Layout margins use multiples of 8. Component inner padding always 16+ except dense tables (12px).

TOKEN	VISUAL	VALUE	USAGE
<pre>`\${['s-1','4px';Inline gap between icon and label; dot and label'], ['s-2','8px';Chip padding, tag inline gap, tight row gap'], ['s-3','12px';Table row padding (dense), sidebar nav item padding'], ['s-4','16px';Card inner padding (compact), sidebar padding'], ['s-5','20px';Standard card padding, section inner'], ['s-6','24px';Panel padding, module gap, grid gap large'], ['s-7','32px';Section within panel, popover padding'], ['s-8','40px';Screen padding (horizontal, narrow)], ['s-9','48px';Section gap within a screen'], ['s-10','56px';Screen padding (horizontal, standard)], ['s-11','64px';Section gap between design sections'], ['s-12','96px';Between major page sections'],].map(([t,v,u])=></pre>			
<pre>`\${t}</pre>		<pre>`\${v}</pre>	<pre>`\${u}</pre>
<pre>`.join("")}</pre>			

```

$([[2,'r-1';Rows, cells, dense chips'], [4,'r-2';Inputs, buttons, small cards'], [6,'r-3';Standard cards, panels'], [8,'r-4';Modal dialogs, overlays'], [100,'r-pill';Timer pill, toggle, round tags] ].map(([,r,t,u])=>`

```

```

    ${t}
    ${r}px
    ${u}    `).join("))

```

 elev-0 No shadow Inline elements, table rows	 elev-1 0 1px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.2) Cards, panels	 elev-2 0 4px 16px rgba(0,0,0,0.3) Modals, selected cards	 elev-glass 0 20px 48px rgba(0,0,0,0.6) Timer widget only
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Components

All interactive components follow a strict hierarchy. One primary action per screen.
Destructive actions always text-only or outlined. Never two filled buttons in the same view.

BUTTONS

Primary

Confirm as KGE

Confirm

Outline

Cancel

Remove

Ghost

Use without Calendar

Skip

Mono / CTA

GRANT CALENDAR ACCESS →

CANCEL

Destructive

Remove chain

Icon

⏸

■

+

TAGS & CHIPS

Active

K KGE · ON

#research

#Deep Work

Inactive

#Q2

#synthesis

+ add tag

Status

● CHAIN ACTIVE

● CHAIN BROKEN

● AT RISK

INPUTS

WHEN

Tuesday 14 April · 14:00

CHAIN

Deep Work

DURATION

120 min

WHAT DID YOU DO?

Synthesized three interview transcripts into four themes.

POST-SESSION NOTE

Synthesized the three user interview transcripts into four themes. Got stuck on theme 3 — need to revisit onboarding friction tomorrow.

TOGGLE · SEGMENT · SELECT

```

${Array.from({length:60}).map((_,i) => `
14:02                                     15:02                                     16:02
`)}).join('')

```

7/9

Motion

Motion is earned, not decorative. Transitions must feel instant for productivity tools — 150ms maximum for micro-interactions. Only the Timer widget entrance uses a longer ease.

``${[['Micro · Hover/Focus','80ms','ease-out','Button hover, input focus ring, row highlight','transition: all 80ms ease-out'], ['Standard · State change','150ms','cubic-bezier(0.16,1,0.3,1)','Toggle, segment switch, KGE badge on/off','transition: all 150ms cubic-bezier(0.16,1,0.3,1)'], ['Enter · Panels','200ms','cubic-bezier(0.16,1,0.3,1)','Sidebar, modal, card expansion','transform + opacity in'], ['Enter · Widget pill','320ms','cubic-bezier(0.34,1.56,0.64,1)','Timer widget first appearance (spring overshoot)','scale(0.92)→1 + opacity'], ['Exit','100ms','ease-in','All exits. Faster than enter.','opacity 1→0'], ['Pulse · Live dot','2s','ease-in-out infinite','Session live indicator dot','opacity 1→0.35→1'], ['Blink · Cursor','1s','step-end infinite','Note input cursor','opacity 1→0→1'],].map(([n,dur,ease,ctx,code])⇒``

```
`${n}
  ${dur}          ${ease}
  ${code}

`),join("}")
```

- + No page-level transitions in macOS app context — window draws are handled by the OS.
- + Do not animate layout/geometry of data tables or the heatmap grid — it creates visual noise.
- + Respect prefers-reduced-motion: wrap all transitions in @media (prefers-reduced-motion: no-preference).

Patterns

Recurring design decisions codified as rules. Use these before inventing something new.

`${{ ['Hierarchy without color','Use typeface role (serif/sans/mono) to establish hierarchy before reaching for opacity. Increase font-size or switch face before dimming text.'], ['Numbers always mono','Any digit — time, duration, count, percentage — must use JetBrains Mono. No exceptions. Even inside a serif headline (wrap the number in a mono span).'], ['One action per screen','Every screen has one primary CTA. Secondary actions are ghost or text-only. Never two filled buttons.'], ['Hairline grids, not shadows','Separate content areas with 0.5px lines, never with border-radius+shadow combos unless elevated (modal/widget). Shadow = elevation, line = boundary.'], ['KGE monogram','The italic K in Instrument Serif is the brand mark. Always italic. Used at 10–28px as a logo/monogram in nav, onboarding, session notes.'], ['Empty states','If a screen has no data, show a single large serif italic placeholder line. Never an illustration, icon, or CTA. Let the emptiness speak.'], ['Metadata labeling','All metadata labels: JetBrains Mono · 10px · +1.2px tracking · uppercase · var(--dim). Never use bold for labels.'], ['Session state indicators','Live sessions get a pulsing 6px dot in var(--text) with a glow. Completed sessions get a static dot. Missed sessions use var(--faint).'], ['Don't break the chain copy','Milestone copy: always lower case, terse, factual. "43 days." not "🔥 Congratulations!'. No emoji. No exclamation marks.'], ['Scrollbar','macOS auto-hides scrollbars. Do not style them. Respect system behavior.'],].map(([title,rule],i) =>``

```
RULE
${String(i+1).padStart(2,'0')}      ${rule}

${title}

`).join(")}


```

K